

CONSTITUTION AND BY-LAWS
of the
**Digital Animal Sustainability &
One Welfare Foundation Africa**
(DASOWF Africa)

A Non-Governmental, Non-Profit Organisation · Pan-African Mandate

PREAMBLE

We, the founding member of the Digital Animal Sustainability & One Welfare Foundation Africa, acknowledging that the productivity and welfare of animals are inextricably linked to human well-being and environmental health across Africa, and firmly convinced that digital innovation is the most powerful catalyst for achieving a sustainable, equitable, and science-driven transformation of the continent's animal production systems, hereby adopt this Constitution as the supreme governing instrument of the Foundation.

ARTICLE I — NAME, IDENTITY AND REGISTERED OFFICE

- 1.1** The full name of the organisation is the Digital Animal Sustainability & One Welfare Foundation Africa, operating under the acronym DASOWF Africa (hereinafter "the Foundation").
- 1.2** The Foundation is a non-governmental, non-profit organisation established in accordance with the laws of its country of registration, and shall operate without discrimination on grounds of race, gender, religion, ethnicity, or nationality.
- 1.3** The registered office shall be situated in Africa at an address designated by the Board of Trustees, and may be changed by Board resolution with notification to the relevant registration authority.
- 1.4** The Foundation may establish regional offices, country desks, or programme hubs across Africa as operational needs require.

ARTICLE II — VISION, MISSION AND OBJECTIVES

- 2.1 Vision:** A digitally transformed African animal production sector that is sustainable, welfare-centred, climate-resilient, and capable of delivering food and nutrition security for all.
- 2.2 Mission:** To accelerate the adoption of digital technologies across African animal production value chains, integrating One Welfare principles — the interconnectedness of animal welfare, human well-being, and environmental health — to achieve lasting sustainability and productivity gains.
- 2.3 Objectives:** The Foundation shall pursue the following objectives:

- (a) Achieve the digital transformation of animal production across Africa by promoting, facilitating, and supporting the adoption of artificial intelligence (AI), the Internet of Things (IoT), big data analytics, precision livestock farming, digital traceability systems, e-commerce platforms, and related technologies throughout livestock and aquaculture value chains.
- (b) Advance One Welfare principles by developing programmes that simultaneously address animal welfare, human well-being, and environmental sustainability as interdependent goals.
- (c) Build digital capacity among smallholder farmers, veterinarians, extension workers, and agribusiness operators through training, mentorship, and knowledge-exchange platforms.
- (d) Promote evidence-based research and publication on digital innovation in animal production, with particular attention to Sub-Saharan Africa's diverse agro-ecological contexts.
- (e) Advocate for gender-inclusive and youth-oriented digital agricultural policies that ensure equitable access to technology benefits across all demographics.
- (f) Foster strategic partnerships with governments, universities, development organisations, the private sector, and international bodies to co-create and scale digital solutions.
- (g) Mobilise financial resources transparently and accountably to fund programmes aligned with the Foundation's mission.

ARTICLE III — GUIDING PRINCIPLES

3.1 The Foundation shall be guided in all its activities by the following principles:

- (a) Inclusivity — ensuring that digital transition benefits reach smallholder farmers, women, youth, and marginalised communities without exception.
- (b) Scientific Integrity — grounding all programmes and publications in rigorous, peer-reviewed evidence.
- (c) One Welfare — recognising that animal health, human well-being, and environmental sustainability must be advanced together.
- (d) Transparency and Accountability — maintaining open governance, accurate financial reporting, and regular public communication of outcomes.
- (e) Pan-African Identity — celebrating Africa's diversity while fostering regional integration and South-South collaboration.

ARTICLE IV — MEMBERSHIP

4.1 Membership is open to individuals, institutions, and organisations that subscribe to the Foundation's vision and mission and whose conduct is consistent with its guiding principles.

4.2 Categories of membership — Founding Members, Ordinary Members, Associate Members, Institutional Members, and Honorary Members — together with their rights, obligations, and admission procedures, shall be defined in the By-Laws.

ARTICLE V — GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

5.1 The Foundation shall be governed by: (a) the General Assembly — the supreme decision-making body of all registered members, convening at least annually; (b) the Board of Trustees — the executive governing body of 5–11 elected Trustees responsible for strategic oversight and

financial stewardship; (c) the Secretariat — the operational arm headed by an Executive Director appointed by the Board; and (d) Advisory and Technical Committees providing expert guidance on digital innovation, animal welfare, research, and other programmatic areas.

5.2 The Board shall elect from among its members a Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson, Secretary, and Treasurer, each serving a renewable three-year term.

5.3 Board decisions shall require a simple majority of a quorate meeting (more than half the Board). General Assembly decisions shall require a simple majority, except constitutional amendments, which require a two-thirds majority.

ARTICLE VI — FINANCE AND ASSETS

6.1 Funds shall be derived from membership fees, grants, donations, research contracts, programme partnerships, investment income, and any other lawful source approved by the Board.

6.2 All funds and assets shall be administered exclusively for the Foundation's stated purposes and shall not be distributed to members or Trustees except as reasonable remuneration for services rendered.

6.3 The financial year runs from 1 January to 31 December. Audited accounts shall be presented to the General Assembly annually.

ARTICLE VII — DISSOLUTION

7.1 The Foundation may be dissolved by a resolution supported by at least three-quarters of members at a General Assembly convened for that purpose, with at least 21 days' written notice.

7.2 Upon dissolution, after settling all liabilities, remaining assets shall be transferred to one or more African non-profit organisations with objects similar to those of the Foundation.

ARTICLE VIII — AMENDMENTS

8.1 This Constitution may be amended by a two-thirds majority at a duly constituted General Assembly, provided proposed amendments have been circulated to all members at least 30 days before the meeting.

ARTICLE IX — COMMENCEMENT

9.1 This Constitution was adopted by the Founding Members on the date stated below and comes into force immediately upon adoption.

ARTICLE X — DUTIES OF OFFICERS

10.1 Chairperson: The Chairperson shall preside over meetings, provide strategic leadership, and represent the Foundation in official matters.

10.2 Vice-Chairperson: The Vice-Chairperson shall assist the Chairperson and act in his or her absence.

10.3 Secretary: The Secretary shall keep minutes, records, correspondence, and official documents of the Foundation.

10.4 Treasurer: The Treasurer shall receive, safeguard, and account for the funds of the Foundation and present financial reports to the Board and General Assembly.

ADOPTED AND SIGNED BY THE FOUNDING MEMBERS

We, the undersigned, hereby adopt this Constitution as the supreme governing instrument of the Digital Animal Sustainability & One Welfare Foundation Africa.

Chairperson — Name: Courage MacCarthy Vuvor (PhD)

Vice-Chairperson — Name: Cosmos Gameli Kwashigah Vuvor

Secretary — Name: Millicent Darkwah

Treasurer — Name: Precious Emefa Vuvor-Konu

Founding Member — Name: Andrews Awuni

Date of Adoption: 5th May 2026

Place of Adoption: Kumasi